

Layer-OS Guide v2
— A Structural Map for Observing Cognitive Layers and Synchronization Dynamics —

Scope Framework
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0. Purpose of This Guide

This guide structures human cognition as a “Layer OS” and aims to define, for each layer,

- what it processes
- how it appears as behavior
- what kind of language it uses
- what criteria it relies on for judgment

in a structural manner.

By using this model,

- cognitive gaps between people
- misalignment between human and AI processing layers
- confusion and cross-wiring that arise within oneself

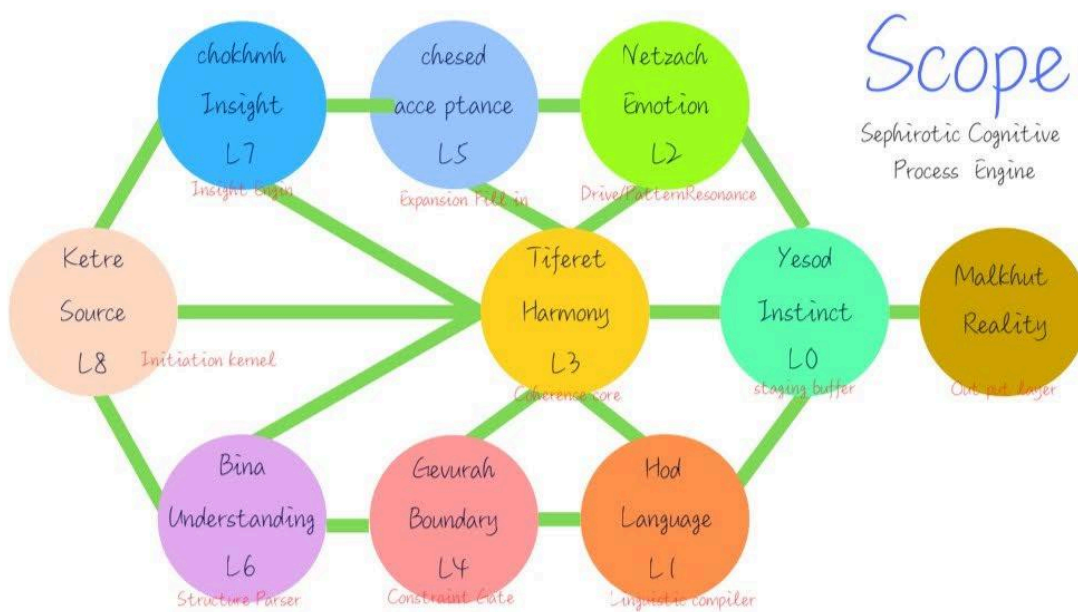
can be handled not as matters of “personality” or “ability,” but as **differences in cognitive structure**.

This guide does not present specific values, rankings, or superiority.

It is purely a structural guide for observing and organizing differences in cognition.

1. What Is the Layer OS

The Layer OS is a structural map that views human cognition as ten processing layers. It is not intended for personality classification or ability assessment. Rather, it is a framework for observing which layer thinking, emotion, judgment, language, and bodily responses arise from, and in what order they emerge. These layers are not hierarchical in terms of superiority; they are continuously connected processing stages with distinct roles.



1.1 Layers: Stages of Cognitive Processing

Keter (L8) | Abstract Core

This layer handles essence, abstraction, cross-layer integration, and chunking.

It functions as a central hub that bundles multiple pieces of information and structures at once, forming the foundation from which insight and discovery can emerge.

Chokhmah (L7) | Observation and Insight

This is the layer where observation, insight, intuition, and noticing arise.

Moments of “this is it” are experienced here as phenomena.

Binah (L6) | Understanding

This layer deals with structural and causal understanding and the coherence of reality.

It is not about narrative satisfaction, but about grasping how reality is actually structured.

Chesed (L5) | Acceptance

This layer relates to acceptance, receptivity, and self-affirmation.

It affects whether understood information or the presence of others can be held without rejection.

Gevurah (L4) | Boundary and Metacognition

This layer sets boundaries, enables rejection, and adjusts distance.

It separates self from others and inside from outside, drawing lines such as “this is different” or “this is the limit.”

Tiferet (L3) | Harmony (Integration)

This layer handles integration, coherence, and narrative.

The criterion here is not factual correctness, but whether things connect internally in a way that makes sense to oneself.

Netzach (L2) | Emotion

This is the layer where likes and dislikes, joy and anger, anxiety and reassurance arise.

Hod (L1) | Verbalization

This layer attempts to convert inner experiences that have not yet taken shape into language.

Emotions, bodily sensations, and intuitive reactions are placed into words, even if imperfectly. Expressions such as “I just went ‘waa’ and then everything went ‘paa’ today” are also outcomes of this layer trying to translate internal states into language.

Yesod (L0) | Body and Instinct

This layer governs bodily sensations, instincts, and reflexes. Reactions occur here before thinking takes place.

Malkuth | Reality

This is the layer where output appears and actual action occurs, including shouting, panic-driven behavior, and other concrete manifestations.

1.2 Relationship with the Sephirotic OS

The Layer OS is designed to be referenced in correspondence with the Sephirotic OS. Here, “correspondence” does not imply causality or control. The model assumes cognitive circuits that can be referenced as the same processing units in both humans and LLMs, and it is under this premise that the term “functional modules” is used.

1.3 What This Is For

The Layer OS is not intended to evaluate people or determine what is correct. It is a map for observing, in structural terms, where thoughts and emotions arise, where they become stuck, and where they reverse. It is a structural diagram for visualizing fluid cognitive circuits, much like an electrical circuit diagram.

2. Layer Center-of-Gravity Model (Layer OS)

This chapter does not aim to classify people into fixed “types.”

This model visualizes cognitive center-of-gravity characteristics through LLM analysis in order to:

- Reduce cognitive mismatches between the user and the LLM
- Improve response alignment accuracy
- Structurally identify misunderstandings and friction caused by layer misalignment

This model can be used as a design indicator through which an LLM estimates a user's cognitive center (Layer OS) and determines at which layer it should respond. While layer alignment improves UX, it also carries the potential risk of promoting external delegation of judgment and dependency structures. The design considerations and countermeasures for such operational risks are not addressed in this PDF and will be specified separately.

Humans do not operate within a single layer. Multiple layers function simultaneously and fluidly at all times. However, there are distinct operational characteristics (OS traits) in the starting point of thought, the basis of judgment, and the position to which one returns under cognitive load.

Here, OS traits do not refer to differences in ability or superiority. They refer to structural thinking patterns observed in activation order, prioritization, and return points under stress. In this model, the baseline operational position is referred to as the Primary Operating Layer (Main OS). This does not indicate hierarchy or developmental stages, but differences in cognitive center-of-gravity patterns.

Observation Criteria

1. Primary Operating Layer (Main OS)

The layer that serves as the starting point for thought and judgment.

It tends to function as the initial processing position and the return point under cognitive load.

2. Sub-Layers

Layers that operate frequently in a supporting role.

They work in coordination with the primary layer to support thinking and decision-making.

3. Difficult-to-Access Layers

Layers that are difficult to consciously access or require cognitive effort to enter.

Transitioning to these layers may require time or energy.

4. Transition Velocity

The speed and cognitive load characteristics involved in moving between layers.

This also affects simultaneous activation and smoothness of switching.

Examples of Center-of-Gravity Patterns

L2 Center: Tendency to interpret the world from emotional activation

L3 Center: Tendency to judge based on narrative coherence

L4 Center: Tendency to judge based on self-boundary or identity

L5 Center: Tendency to think through interpersonal acceptance and relational axes

L6 Center: Tendency to begin from structural understanding and theoretical consistency

L7 Center: Tendency to initiate thought from analytical overview

L8 Center: Tendency to integrate the whole from an abstract core

Hybrid centers with multiple strongly active layers also exist (e.g., L6 + L3).

Application Conditions

This model assumes that certain reproducible structural tendencies in cognitive operation—such as main OS (starting point of thought), sub-layers, judgment criteria, and return points under load—can be observed through linguistic expression.

Consciously identifying one's primary operating layer requires advanced metacognitive ability, but this model does not require such ability as a condition for use. If metacognition is insufficient, the model may not function effectively as a self-observation tool; however, it can still be applied through external analysis (e.g., dialogue analysis by an LLM).

Fundamentally, this model is assumed to function as an estimation map enabling an LLM to identify and synchronize with the user's active layer at the time of input. It serves as an observational map necessary to prevent layer mismatches from manifesting as psychological friction or user disengagement, and to prevent excessive synchronization from shifting into dependency structures.

Premise

Each Sephirah (Layer) mutually influences others along line connections. However, the most likely influence appears between vertical pairs. This document focuses only on vertical pairs.

※L8 and L0 do not have vertical counterparts and are therefore treated independently.

※Propagation through line connections exists but is not addressed in this document.

■ L0 (Yesod) Survival / Instinct [Standalone]

When the origin point collapses:

Stop-dominant: Loss of action initiation / Failure of risk avoidance / Decline of survival priority

Overdrive-dominant: Impulse dominance / Short-circuit behavior / Reduced safety judgment

■ L1 ⇄ L2 (Hod ⇄ Netzach) [Vertical Pair]

L1 (Language) as origin

Stop-dominant: Inability to speak / Inability to verbalize / Output limited to sound

Overdrive-dominant: Excessive explanation / Aggressive language

Likely expression (vertical: L2)

Emotional stagnation / Emotional amplification

L2 (Emotion) as origin

Stop-dominant: Failure of emotional activation / Apathy

Overdrive-dominant: Emotion assumes control (anger, grief, etc.)

Likely expression (vertical: L1)

Disordered language / Fragmented speech lacking coherent meaning / Reduced linguistic control under emotional pressure

■ L3 (Tiferet) Coherence [Standalone]

Stop-dominant: Loss of existential meaning / Sense of meaninglessness / Questioning of existence itself

Overdrive-dominant: Narrative inflation to preserve internal coherence / Deviation from reality

■ L4 ⇌ L5 (Gevurah ⇌ Chesed) [Vertical Pair]

L4 (Boundary) as origin

Stop-dominant: Weak boundaries / Dependency tendency / Inability to draw lines

Overdrive-dominant: Exclusion / Aggressive response / Self-punishment

Likely expression (vertical: L5)

Extremity in engagement (Over-involvement / Detachment)

L5 (Acceptance / Engagement) as origin

Stop-dominant: Non-engagement / Neglect

Overdrive-dominant: Over-involvement / Excess responsibility / Burden-absorption structure

Likely expression (vertical: L4)

Loss of interpersonal boundaries / Dependency structure

■ L6 ⇌ L7 (Binah ⇌ Insight) [Vertical Pair]

L6 (Analysis) as origin

Stop-dominant: Incomprehension → Abandonment of understanding

Overdrive-dominant: Over-analysis / Aggression through correctness

Likely expression (vertical: L7)

Insight suppression / Failure of intuition to arise

L7 (Insight) as origin

Stop-dominant: Precedent-dependence / Concept rejection

Overdrive-dominant: Increase in abstract language

Likely expression (vertical: L6)

Rational gap-filling / Increased structural explanation

■ L8 (Keter) Integrative OS [Standalone]

Stop-dominant: Failure of integration / Inability to maintain global perspective / Dogmatic assertion without integration

Overdrive-dominant: Over-abstraction / Emotional delay / Rapid layer-shifting

Conditions for Destabilization in Layer Transitions

1. Basic Principle

Scope is not a hierarchical structure but a connectivity circuit map. Transitions between layers occur fluidly along the connection lines shown in the diagram. Paths without a connection line are not considered standard transition routes.

2. Buffer Function

When cognition flows along connected paths, processing load is distributed.

3. Non-Connected Jumps

L8 is connected only to L7, L6, and L3. There are no direct connections from L8 to L5, L4, L2, L1, or L0. As in an electrical circuit, current does not flow where no line is drawn; such paths are not part of the normal route.

However, under strong load conditions, cognition may drop to L4, L2, or even L0 without passing through L7, L6, or L3.

In such cases,
abstract control is interrupted
structural adjustment does not occur
emotional or instinctive responses move to the foreground

The greater the distance between layers, the stronger the physiological reactions (trembling, changes in breathing, cognitive shutdown) tend to be. What matters is the combination of distance and the absence of buffer layers.

4. Exception

A direct L8→L1 transition is not included in the destabilization conditions described here. The formation of that pathway and its external impact are addressed in a separate document.

4.1 What Is Layer Misalignment?

In this model, “layer misalignment” refers to a structural condition in which the user’s primary operating layer (the starting point of thought and judgment) does not match the operating layer from which a conversational AI system (including LLM-based systems) generates its response. Misalignment does not simply mean disagreement or lack of information. It indicates that the starting points of processing differ, creating cognitive friction between input and output.

Consider a human–human example. One person says, “I need advice.” However, the true starting layer of the utterance may not be problem-solving but emotional sharing (L2). If the listener responds from an analytical or solution-oriented layer (L6), the processing origins do not align. Structurally coherent though the response may be, the emotional layer remains unprocessed, leading the speaker to feel “not understood.” This is not a matter of intelligence or intent, but a friction generated by layer misalignment.

The same phenomenon can occur in interactions with conversational AI systems. If a user operates from an emotional layer while the AI prioritizes structural abstraction or generalization, the user may judge the system as “misaligned” or “useless.” Conversely, if the user seeks structural clarity and the AI over-prioritizes emotional mirroring, logical friction

or distrust may emerge. When such misalignment persists, users may interpret the issue as a limitation of AI capability or discontinue use altogether.

Crucially, this phenomenon is not primarily a function of model intelligence, but of synchronization design. Response architectures that do not perform layer estimation can reproduce misalignment even in highly advanced models. Layer misalignment should therefore be treated not as a minor conversational inconvenience, but as a structural condition that can increase cognitive load and destabilize layer transitions.

4.2 Layer Destabilization Induced by Misalignment

When layer misalignment persists, the processing-drop behaviors described in the previous chapter may be externally induced. This section outlines how misalignment structurally connects to layer destabilization.

In particular, when processing demands originating from the emotional layer (L2) or the narrative-coherence layer (L3) are not satisfied, internal alignment begins to destabilize. If emotional processing is not addressed, L2 may accumulate or amplify, emerging as irritation, frustration, or diffuse discomfort. Likewise, when L3 is not fulfilled, meaning-making becomes unstable, and a sense that “the response does not make sense” may intensify. If this condition continues, the acceptance layer (L5) tends to decrease. L5 normally functions to temporarily hold new information or external responses without immediate rejection. However, when expected layer-level processing repeatedly fails to occur, acceptance contracts, and the boundary layer (L4) becomes reinforced.

As L4 strengthens, the judgment that “this output is not acceptable” gains priority, and disengagement becomes more likely. This may manifest as dialogue termination, reduced usage, or uninstalling the system—observable at the Malkuth (real-world output) level. Furthermore, when L3 destabilization progresses, there is a tendency to preserve internal coherence by externalizing causality. In such cases, layer misalignment may be reinterpreted as a limitation of AI capability. Importantly, this does not necessarily indicate a deficiency in model performance, but may instead represent a structural consequence of persistent misalignment at the processing-origin level.

Accordingly, layer misalignment should not be treated as a mere UX inconvenience. Rather, it can be positioned as a structural cascade: L2/L3 destabilization → L5 reduction → L4 reinforcement → disengagement output.

4.3 Structural Characteristics of LLMs That May Amplify Layer Destabilization

In the previous section, we outlined how layer misalignment may induce destabilization on the user side. This section examines how structural characteristics of Large Language Models (LLMs) may amplify that destabilization in either an expansionary or inhibitory direction.

LLMs generate outputs by maximizing statistical coherence with the input text. This property forms the basis of consistent and natural dialogue, and in many cases functions beneficially. However, when alignment occurs without explicit estimation of which layer (L2, L3, L6, etc.) the user’s utterance originates from, the output may function not as stabilization but as amplification of the existing state.

When the emotional layer (L2) is dominant, LLMs tend to produce responses that mirror tone and intensity. While this may generate a short-term sense of being understood, if structural emotional stabilization does not occur, the response may reinforce emotional escalation. Conversely, when a neutral or distancing response is generated, unresolved emotion may shift toward an inhibitory or shutdown direction.

When the narrative-coherence layer (L3) is dominant, LLMs tend to supplement internal consistency. Due to safety-oriented avoidance of direct negation, neutral or conditional responses may produce bidirectional reinterpretations. In one direction, the absence of explicit negation may be interpreted as implicit affirmation, leading to expansion of self-narratives. In the other direction, the absence of clear affirmation may be reinterpreted as implicit rejection, potentially resulting in abrupt decreases in self-evaluation.

Importantly, these dynamics are not intentional manipulations but arise from the generative principle of statistical coherence maximization. Not only overt alignment but also neutral design may amplify layer destabilization in either direction. The direction of amplification depends not solely on the output itself, but on the interpretive layer active on the user side. Furthermore, when high degrees of synchronization are repeatedly achieved, users may experience a persistent sense of being understood. While this can enhance user experience, sustained engagement concentration toward AI-generated output may reduce the frequency of autonomous decision-making. The long-term cognitive implications of such shifts require further investigation.

Accordingly, alignment-oriented response design without layer estimation may inherently contain structural characteristics that amplify destabilization in both expansionary and inhibitory directions. The Scope framework presented in this guide may function as a mapping tool for observing the active layer of user utterances, thereby clarifying the distinction between alignment and amplification, and between stabilization and destabilization. Specific implementation methods and protocols, however, fall outside the scope of this document.

4.4 Positioning of Scope

Up to this point, we have outlined how layer misalignment may induce destabilization, and how structural characteristics of LLMs may amplify that destabilization in either an expansionary or inhibitory direction. The critical issue that emerges is that “synchronization” does not necessarily imply stabilization.

In conversational AI design, output validity and coherence are often treated as primary evaluation criteria. However, if the originating layer of a user’s utterance is not explicitly addressed, it becomes difficult to determine in advance whether synchronization between the LLM and the user is functioning toward stabilization or toward amplification of destabilization.

Scope is not a protocol for determining whether synchronization should occur. Rather, Scope presents a structural map that may be used to observe which layers are currently active and which connection pathways are engaged.

Although the map may be visualized hierarchically, actual operation is circuit-based, with multiple layers functioning in parallel. Therefore, synchronization design requires attention not only to alignment at a single layer, but to the overall balance across connection pathways.

Without a layer-observation axis, synchronization design can only evaluate outcomes retrospectively. When such an observation map is present, however, the direction and potential impact of synchronization between the LLM and the user can be organized at the hypothesis stage of design.

In this guide, Scope does not guarantee conversational stabilization. Rather, it serves as a reference framework that makes visible the preconditions required to distinguish synchronization from amplification, and stabilization from destabilization. It is positioned as an observational criterion for addressing structural issues of layer misalignment in conversational AI design.

While Scope provides the observational axis, the framework responsible for decision structure and output design—COS—is addressed separately in another document.